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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Lawmaker seeks hearing on attacks

US strikes on boats in Caribbean raise tensions in region

By Eric Schmitt
The New York Times

The top Democrat on the House Armed Services Committee on Monday called for his panel to hold a hearing to examine the Trump

administration's use of the military in the Caribbean Sea to kill people suspected of smuggling drugs as if they were enemy soldiers in a war, rather than arresting them as criminals.

The demand by the lawmaker, Rep. Adam Smith of Washington, came a day after Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth announced that the military had attacked another vessel — the seventh since early

September — in the region.

The Trump administration has acknowledged killing more than 30 people in the strikes.

"President Trump and his administration continue to fail to answer pressing questions regarding the president's orders to carry out lethal U.S. military strikes on boats in the Caribbean Sea," Smith said in a statement.

"They have failed to demon-

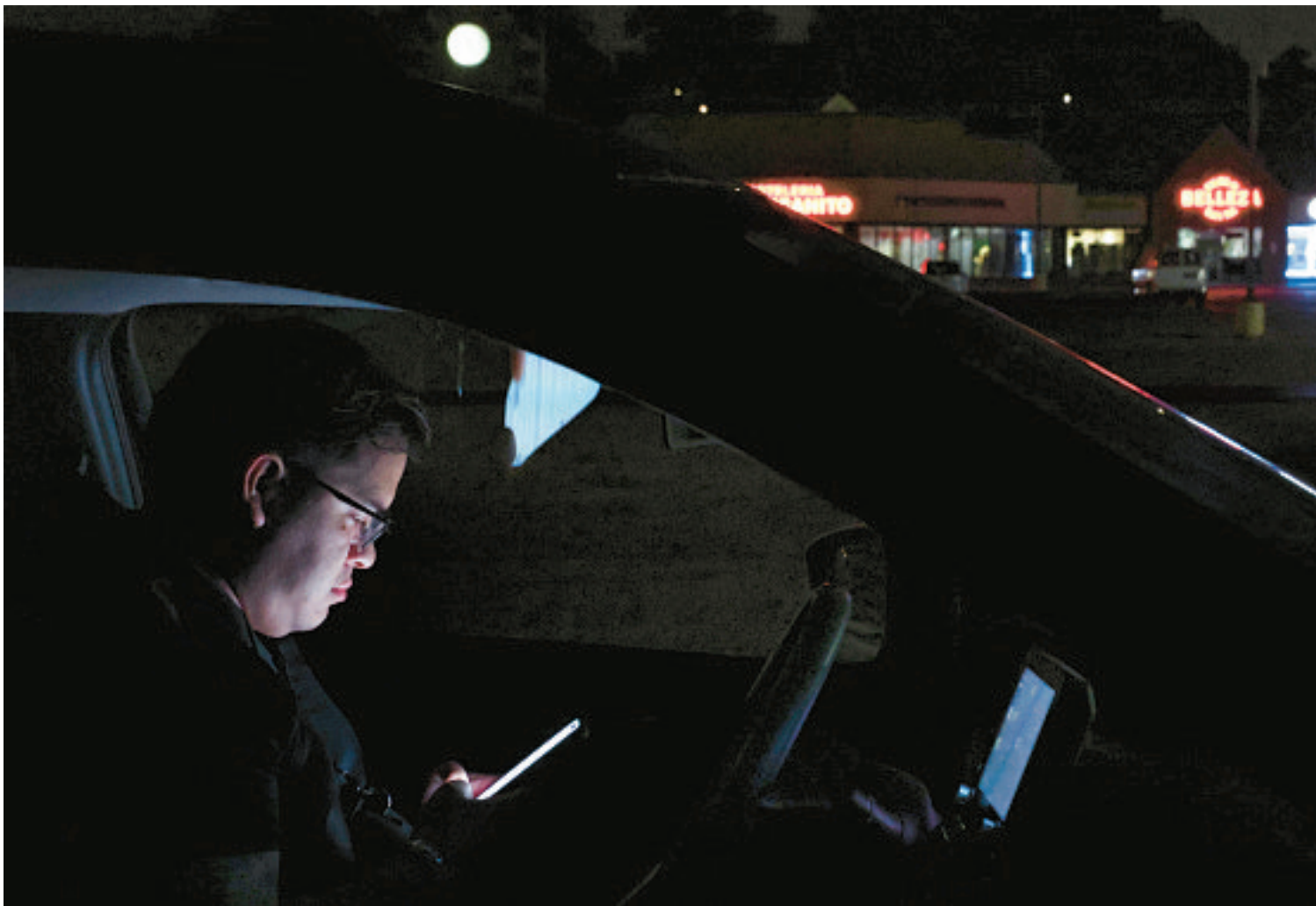
strate the legality of these strikes, provide transparency on the process used or even a list of cartels that have been designated as terrorist organizations," he added. "We have also yet to see any evidence to support the president's unilateral determinations that these vessels or their activities posed imminent threats to the United States of America that warranted military force rather

than law enforcement-led interdiction."

Holding any committee hearing would be up to the House Republican leadership. Speaker Mike Johnson has kept the House in recess during the three-week government shutdown.

The Republican-led Congress (especially the House) has ceded

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Ismael Cordová-Clough sits in his car at Clock Tower Plaza at 4:55 a.m. and sifts through messages from residents about potential U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement activity in Elgin in September. Cordová-Clough is part of a volunteer patrol group that documents federal agents in the area and livestreams their activities in order to alert the community. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

One man's ICE watchdog work begins early in Elgin

Cordová-Clough's updates polarizing in immigrant community

By Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

Ismael Cordová-Clough slipped out before dawn most mornings, while the rest of the block slept. By 4 a.m., he was circling the same

streets he grew up on, scanning corners, alleyways and factory lots for unmarked cars.

He goes by "Ish" on Facebook, where he has become a trusted but polarizing voice in Elgin's immigrant community, documenting sightings of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement and posting real-time updates. His videos often show tense, chaotic moments: neighbors being

detained, agents refusing to answer questions, bystanders shouting in fear or solidarity.

Cordová-Clough, 28, recently left Elgin, but he said his feed remains a crucial part of the local resistance — especially since the Trump administration ramped up enforcement five weeks ago. Public demonstrations and chants are one way of protest, but Cordová-Clough and other organizers

say they focus on evidence.

"People share old photos, misinformation all the time," he said. "We try to verify in real time, with people who actually live here."

Though now a sharp voice in local immigrant advocacy, Cordová-Clough didn't start in this work. He was a student organizer and

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State asks Supreme Court to abstain

Attorneys argue against stay on National Guard deployment ruling

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Attorneys for Illinois on Monday asked the U.S. Supreme Court to deny the Trump administration's "dramatic" request to be allowed to send National Guard troops to the Chicago area to help with immigration enforcement while the issue is on appeal.

In the 46-page response, the state said it would be inappropriate for the high court to get involved at this stage in the proceedings, where a district court's decision has yet to be decided on appeal.

The filing also said lawyers for Trump offered "no meaningful response" to the factual basis for U.S. District Judge April Perry's Oct. 9 temporary restraining order, adding that declarations submitted by a series of immigration officials outlining purported violence against agents and out-of-control protests simply did not hold water.

"In fact, applicants do not even attempt to rebut that much of the activity the declarants complained about was constitutionally protected," the state response stated.

The filing also noted Perry is scheduled to hold a hearing Wednesday to determine if her two-week restraining order should be extended.

The filing came just hours after a divided appeals court in Oregon overturned a lower court's decision and ruled that Trump does have the authority to send National Guard troops into Portland to quell what the president has described as a prolonged and violent "siege"

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Keeping the peace

President Donald Trump's envoys traveled to Israel on Monday after the country threatened to halt shipments of humanitarian aid to Gaza. Israel accused Hamas militants of killing two soldiers. U.S. special envoy Steve Witkoff and the president's son-in-law Jared Kushner met with Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu. **Nation & World**

A chance for revenge

Ravens linebacker Roquan Smith gets another chance to face his former team when the Bears travel to Baltimore on Sunday. The Bears traded him in 2022, and he has been named first-team All Pro in three consecutive seasons. **Chicago Sports**

Immigration officials defend tough actions



A U.S. Customs and Border Patrol agent walks through a cloud of tear gas after agents faced off against community members at 105th Street and Avenue N in Chicago on Oct. 14. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Tell judge aggressive tactics a response to agents being in danger

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A pair of immigration officials testifying in federal court Monday defended their agencies' use of force with protesters and media during the Trump administration's ongoing "Operation Midway Blitz," saying agents have been put in dangerous situations on the streets, pelted with eggs and rocks and forced to use tear gas and other tactics to get out of pop-up protests in dense neighborhoods.

But at the same time, the offi-

cials told U.S. District Judge Sara Ellis that all agents had been fully briefed on the judge's temporary restraining order restricting the use of tear gas and requiring body-worn cameras for all officers in the field to be turned on during enforcement actions.

"We take these (temporary restraining orders) very seriously," Kyle Harvick, deputy incident commander for Customs and Border Patrol, told Ellis, adding that in addition to being emailed to every agent in the field, Ellis' orders have been discussed at length during daily morning briefings.

Harvick, who appeared in

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TODAY'S WEATHER



High **55** Low **44**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

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